XUECHU ZHANG

2902301Z@student.gla.ac.uk | Psychology, communication, and human-AI interaction

EDUCATION

University of Glasgow - BSc (Hons) Psychology, expected 2027. Expected First Class Honours. Undergraduate Excellence Scholarship: GBP 28,000 total.

University of Hong Kong - Psychology exchange student, 2025-2026.

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign - Summer Research Visitor, 2026.

SELECTED RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

University of Southern California - AI-Assisted Interpersonal Communication

Project lead | Prof. Angel Hsing-Chi Hwang | 2026-Present

- Lead theoretical framing and mixed-methods analyses across two pilots (n = 55; n = 45) and a main study (n = 222).
- Develop coding frameworks for chatbot logs, interviews, and open-ended responses; integrate these with pre-post measures and mixed-effects analyses.
- Preliminary analyses indicate higher perceived sincerity and willingness to use AI support, alongside lower ownership and perspective-taking. Manuscript in preparation for ICA.

University of Glasgow - Shared Virtual Humans and Human Group Dynamics

Project lead, independent research | Dr. Chen Zhou | 2026-Present

- Develop an experiment examining whether private interactions with a shared virtual human shape later trust, cooperation, and cohesion among strangers.
- Refine a planned immediate-versus-seven-day-delayed first-meeting comparison using independent groups; develop hypotheses and pilot procedures.

CARE Lab, University of Hong Kong - Gaming Disorder Umbrella Review

Research assistant | Prof. Cecilia Cheng | 2025-May 2026

- Screen and code approximately 400 meta-analyses; contribute to the synthesis of 69 eligible reviews.
- Extract effect sizes, study characteristics, methodological features, and intervention outcomes; contribute to theoretical interpretation.
- Co-author a manuscript under review at Nature Human Behaviour.

ADDITIONAL RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Social Perception Lab, University of Glasgow

Research assistant | Prof. Rachael Jack | 2024-2025

- Investigate facial, vocal, and multimodal signals of sincerity and moral intent across cultures.
- Integrate behavioral and text-derived measures in reproducible R workflows; contribute to preregistration and analysis materials.

ADDITIONAL RESEARCH EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

Digital Diaspora and Identity Processes on Xiaohongshu

Independent study | University of Hong Kong | 2025-2026

- Design and conduct a pilot qualitative analysis of 30 posts on identity negotiation, belonging, and cross-cultural adjustment.
- Develop a coding framework for belonging, social support, and self-presentation.

Instructor Presence and Cognitive Load in L2 Multimedia Learning

Independent experimental research | University of Glasgow | 2025

- Design and conduct a study with 79 non-native English-speaking participants.
- Analyze cognitive-load measures in R using a 2 x 2 mixed ANOVA, assumption checks, and effect-size estimates.

Anxiety and Alcohol Use in University Students

Independent quantitative research | University of Glasgow | 2025

- Analyze a 607-participant dataset in R; evaluate null findings, effect sizes, and alternative explanations.
- Produce an APA-style manuscript with a reproducible statistical workflow.

SELECTED MANUSCRIPTS

Gaming disorder prevalence, psychosocial correlates, and intervention outcomes: an umbrella review of meta-analyses. With Cecilia Cheng and collaborators. Under review at Nature Human Behaviour.

AI-Assisted Interpersonal Communication and the Trade-Off Between Sincerity and Ownership. With Angel Hsing-Chi Hwang and collaborators. In preparation for the ICA Annual Conference.

METHODS AND SKILLS

Quantitative: R, experimental and survey design, mixed ANOVA, mixed-effects modeling, power analysis, and effect-size estimation.
Qualitative: Interview and open-ended response analysis; theory-driven coding.
Evidence synthesis: Systematic screening, effect-size extraction, and methodological coding.
Open science: OSF preregistration and reproducible workflows.
Languages: Mandarin (native); English (fluent).

COMMUNITY CONTRIBUTIONS

Chinese Student Union, University of Glasgow - Student Support Volunteer, 2024-Present.
Xiaohongshu - Chinese-language study-abroad resources and student information sharing; content has received more than one million views.